88 AWESOME IDIOMS TO WOW YOUR TEACHER!

Suitable for Primary to Secondary School Students

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A little Introduction…

I am Jerry Lee, Founder of **WritingSamurai.com** and Director at **Grade Solution Learning Centre**. WritingSamurai.com is an online learning platform where your child can learn from our pre-recorded online courses, while Grade Solution Learning Centre is for physical and live zoom classes - we have a branch at Bugis. To date, there are more than 10,000 enrolments on WritingSamurai.com and we serve more than 1000+ students at Grade Solution Learning Centre yearly.

To summarise our teaching methods, we simply teach your child to **write AWESOME compos without memorising bombastic words or phrases**. We have a lesson plan to guide your child from writing the intro all the way to the conclusion, and we will also train your child in all the technical aspects of writing like vocab, grammar, and sentence structure construction.

We don't promise 'miracle' improvements, but if your child has a good learning attitude, and is able to apply the concepts taught, he or she has a chance of being one of the top writers in class. (No kidding!) You can see the testimonials on our Facebook page by clicking this link here >>> https://www.facebook.com/writingsamurai/

This ebook of 88 Awesome Idioms will expose your child to a wider range of vocabulary, and to encourage your child to use some idioms in his or her compositions. Do take note that you cannot just simply copy and paste the idioms into your writing like some math formula… you need to understand the meaning and the context behind them! With some consistent practice, you should find yourself getting better at writing! Hope you enjoy this ebook!

Cheers,
Jerry Lee
Saving Students, One Word at a Time.

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Are you bored of using the same phrases over and over again?

Idioms are extremely useful when you want to add some colour into your writing.

However, the words in an idiom do not make up its literal meaning. Instead, we have to understand or find out its 'hidden' meaning in order to use it appropriately.

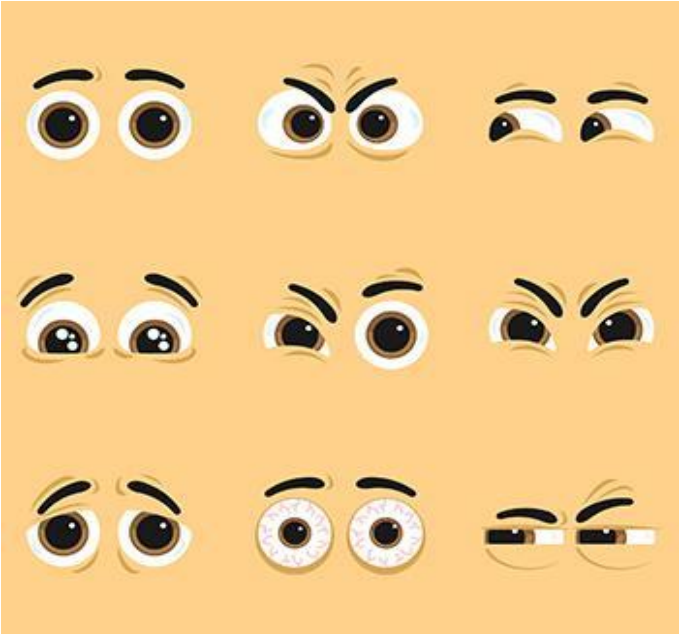
The quirkiness of idioms is what makes them so fun to use and read.

Here are 88 idioms that you can use in your compositions!

1. **A dime a dozen**

Something that is 'a dime a dozen' is very common and not very valuable.

Example: Although John was very proud of his new water bottle, I thought it looked a dime a dozen.



2. **A sight for sore eyes**

'A sight for sore eyes' is used to describe something or someone you are glad to see.

Example: Today turned out to be horrible. The hot meal that Mom prepared for me when I reached home was a sight for sore eyes.

3. **A taste of your own medicine**

To get ‘a taste of your own medicine’ is to experience the same unpleasant thing that you had done to others.

Example: Harry put the fake cockroach into Sally’s pencil case and laughed at her when she screamed. He got a taste of his own medicine when a real cockroach suddenly landed on his desk.

4. **All ears**

To be ‘all ears’ is to be prepared to hear what someone has to say.

Example: “You may explain yourself, I am all ears,” the principal said to Jacob.

5. **At the drop of a hat**

To do something ‘at the drop of a hat’ is to do it immediately.

Example: At the drop of a hat, I ran away from the fierce dog.

6. **Back on one’s feet**

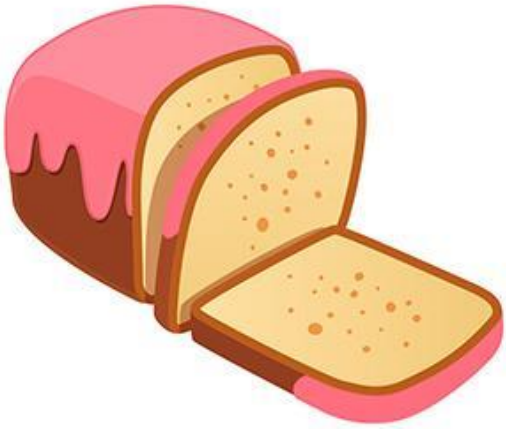
To be ‘back on your feet’ is to recover after a failure.

Example: After losing all his money to gambling, Jack decided to quit. It took him some time before he could get back on his feet and live normally again.

7. **Beat around the bush**

To ‘beat around the bush’ is to intentionally talk about something in a vague manner instead of talking about it directly.

Example: “Stop beating around the bush and tell me who broke the vase!” Mom demanded.



8. Best thing since sliced bread

Something described as the ‘best thing since sliced bread’ is excellent and innovative or new.

Example: The new sea salt and vinegar potato chips flavour is the best thing since sliced bread.

9. Bite the bullet

To ‘bite the bullet’ is to finally accept something unpleasant or something you did not want to do initially.

Example: Sam had to bite the bullet and finish his homework or he would get a scolding from his teacher.

10. Bread and butter

‘Bread and butter’ is usually used to describe a job or something that you get your income from.

Example: Being a writer is Tom’s bread and butter.

11. By the skin of your teeth

‘By the skin of your teeth’ means the same as the word ‘barely’.

Example: I made it to first place in the race by the skin of my teeth.

12. Call it a day

To ‘call it a day’ is to end work for the day.

Example: I finished all my homework before calling it a day.

13. Coast is clear

When the ‘coast is clear’, it means there’s nothing standing in your way.

Example: George was afraid to run into the principal. He made sure the coast is clear before leaving the restroom.

14. Costs an arm and a leg

Something that ‘costs an arm and a leg’ is very expensive.

Example: My father’s Ferrari costs an arm and a leg.

15. Crack up

To ‘crack up’ is to laugh a lot and loudly. You can also cause someone to ‘crack up’.

Example: The clown’s stunts made everyone crack up.

16. Cream of the crop

Something or someone that is described as ‘cream of the crop’ is of the best quality.

Example: Jack was the top student of my class, he was the cream of the crop.

17. Cut somebody some slack

To ‘cut somebody some slack’ is to go easy on that person because he or she had been through enough.

Example: Seeing that Holly was regretful of her actions, the principal decided to cut her some slack and giving her a light punishment.

18. Drive someone up the wall

To ‘drive someone up the wall’ is to make that person very angry or annoyed.

Example: The commotion of the construction work drove me up the wall.

19. Egg someone on

When you ‘egg on’ someone, you are urging them to do something, often something bad.

Example: The bully’s friends egged him on to push Alex.

20. Elephant in the room

The ‘elephant in the room’ is something obviously embarrassing or unpleasant, and no one wants to talk about it.

Example: The room was silent. Then, Mr Tan cleared his throat. “We need to talk about the elephant in the room,” Mr Tan said. “Who broke the window with the basketball?”

21. Fan the flames

To ‘fan the flames’ is to worsen something that is already bad.

Example: The teacher was furious at Eddie because he was caught cheating, but he fanned the flames by arguing with her.

22. Far cry from

Something described as a 'far cry' is very different from something else.

Example: Elizabeth's grade for her latest Maths exam was a far cry from what she expected, and it shocked her.

23. Fish for compliments

When you 'fish for compliments', you are trying to get someone to say something good about you.

Example: She fished for compliments about her new hairstyle by constantly flipping her hair.

24. Fly off the handle

To 'fly off the handle' is to become very angry.

Example: After finding out Jeffrey was responsible for the prank, I flew off the handle.

25. Full of hot air

Someone who is ‘full of hot air’ is someone who is full of nonsense.

Example: “You’re full of hot air,” Cathy said. “I know you were the one who spoiled the computer, so stop trying to blame me.”

26. Get a kick out of something

To ‘get a kick out of something’ is to find something very interesting.

Example: The baby got a kick out of throwing her food at the walls.

27. Get out of hand

Usually used to describe a situation, something that has ‘gotten out of hand’ has lost control.

Example: Without a teacher around, the classroom was like a zoo. The noise was getting out of hand.

28. Get your act together

To ‘get your act together’ is to get yourself organised so that you can achieve something.

Example: I should get my act together if I want to win the race.

29. Get to the bottom of it

To ‘get to the bottom of’ something is to solve an investigation. It is usually used to refer to a situation.

Example: Who could have stolen my wallet? I would not rest until I got to the bottom of it.

30. Give someone a hand

To ‘give a hand’ means the same as ‘help out’.

Example: The old lady was struggling with her groceries, so I gave her a hand.

31. Give something a shot

To ‘give something a shot’ is to try something for the first time.

Example: Despite not being good at sports, Mary decided to give swimming a shot.

32. Give someone the cold shoulder

When you ‘give someone the cold shoulder’, you are ignoring that person.

Example: I gave Barry the cold shoulder when he teased me for my hair.

33. Green light

To get the ‘green light’ is to get permission.

Example: I asked my mother if I could go play soccer with my friends, and she gave me the green light.

34. Go against the grain

To ‘go against the grain’ is to do something that is not typical. It is usually used to praise someone.

Example: Derek constantly went against the grain, that was why he was so innovative.

35. Green with envy

'Green with envy' is used to describe someone who is jealous.

Example: Janet's pretty pencil case made me green with envy.

36. Hit the books

To 'hit the books' is to study hard.

Example: It was very late at night, but Leonard had to hit the books if he wanted to finish his homework by tomorrow.

37. Hit the nail on the head

To 'hit the nail on the head' is to be correct.

Example: The old man was too close to the edge of the platform and Jason was worried he might fall. He hit the nail on the head - the old man suddenly lost his balance and fell onto the train tracks.

38. Hit the roof

To 'hit the roof' is to be very angry.

Example: My mother hit the roof when she found out I had forgotten to buy the salt.

39. Hit the sack / sheets / hay

To 'hit the sack, sheets or hay' is to go to sleep.

Example: After a long day at work, I was relieved to finally hit the sack.

40. Hold one's tongue

To 'hold your tongue' is to not say something even though you want to say it. It is usually used when the thing you want to say is unpleasant.

Example: "Hold your tongue!" Mom warned me just as I was about to argue with her.

41. In the bag

'In the bag' is usually used when we are sure we will win something, usually a competition.

Example: As I had trained very hard, I was confident I had first place in the bag.

42. In the clear

To be ‘in the clear’ is to be safe from punishment or getting caught.

Example: Once he lost the policemen, the robber was in the clear.

43. Joined at the hip

When two people are ‘joined at the hip’, they are close friends and spend a lot of time together.

Example: Karen is my best friend, we are joined at the hip.

44. Jump on the bandwagon

To ‘jump on the bandwagon’ is to follow a trend or do what everyone else is doing.

Example: Since everyone is using Instagram, I decided to jump on the bandwagon too.

45. Keep an eye on something or someone

To ‘keep an eye on something’ is to watch it very closely.

Example: I had to keep an eye on my brother to make sure he was not doing anything dangerous at the playground.

46. Know by heart

To ‘know by heart’ is to have something memorised.

Example: I was lost in the shopping mall but luckily, I knew my parents’ phone numbers by heart.

47. Know something like the back of your hand

To ‘know something like the back of your hand’ is to know something very well.

Example: I would never get lost in the woods. I knew the paths like the back of my hand.

48. Leave no stone unturned

To ‘leave no stone unturned’ is to investigate something very thoroughly.

Example: It was very important that we find the wallet. We had to leave no stone unturned.

49. Let someone off the hook

To ‘let someone off the hook’ is to let them go unpunished.

Example: Even though Patricia had ruined the walls with her crayons, she was let off the hook because she is a baby.

50. Let the cat out of the bag

When we 'let the cat out of the bag', we have revealed a secret.

Example: Jonathan let the cat out of the bag. He pointed at Sean and said, "He came up with the idea for the prank."

51. Lion's share

To have the 'lion's share' of something is to have the biggest portion.

Example: Among my siblings, I had the lion's share of chores to do.

52. Live and learn

To 'live and learn' is to learn from our mistakes and move on.

Example: We have to live and learn if we want to improve ourselves.

53. Make yourself scarce

To 'make yourself scarce' is to do something, like leave the room or hide, so that you won't be seen.

Example: The security guard was approaching, we had to make ourselves scarce before we could get caught!

54. Nip something in the bud

To 'nip something in the bud' is to fix a problem before it becomes too difficult to manage.

Example: Eric did not want the ant nest to grow any bigger, so he decided to nip it in the bud by destroying it with a stick. However, he only angered the ants.

55. On cloud nine

When you are ‘on cloud nine’, you are very happy.

Example: I was on cloud nine as I stood at the top of the slide.

56. On one’s toes

To be ‘on your toes’ is to be active or alert.

Example: Ali knew stray dogs lived in this alleyway, and he was on his toes for any sign of one.

57. On the same page

To be ‘on the same page’ as someone is to agree with them.

Example: I was glad my team was on the same page as me. We got work done quickly.

58. On the ball

To be ‘on the ball’ is to be alert, competent or receptive.

Example: I like having John in my group as he is always on the ball in getting things done.

59. Piece of cake

Something that is a ‘piece of cake’ can be very easily done.

Example: Writing 250 words for an assignment was a piece of cake for Taufik.

60. Pig out

To ‘pig out’ on something is to eat it very heartily.

Example: Once in a while, I like to pig out on french fries.

61. Pipe down

To ‘pipe down’ is to lower the volume. It is often given as an instruction.

Example: “Pipe down!” Mrs Lim demanded once she stepped into the boisterous classroom.

62. Play it by ear

To ‘play it by ear’ is to improvise. When we have to play something by ear, we normally do not have a plan and just do whatever seems right at that moment.

Example: I did not know how to handle a stray dog and had to play it by ear.

63. Pull someone’s leg

To ‘pull someone’s leg’ is to joke with them.

Example: Alex was just pulling Jerry’s leg, but Jerry took the joke seriously.

64. Put one’s foot down

When we ‘put our foot down’, it means we will not be changing our minds about something.

Example: I wanted a new bicycle, but my father did not want to buy one for me. He had put his foot down on this matter.

65. Run like the wind

To ‘run like the wind’ is an idiom used to describe running very quickly.

Example: Once the whistle was blown, the racers ran like the wind.

66. Run out of steam

To ‘run out of steam’ is to be tired out. It is usually used after someone has done something for a very long time and is feeling too exhausted or unmotivated to continue doing it.

Example: After playing for an hour, the two boys had run out of steam.

67. Rain on somebody’s parade

To ‘rain on someone’s parade’ is to ruin someone’s plans or excitement.

Example: Ezra was proud of getting 90 marks for the Maths test, but Tom had to rain on his parade by scoring 100 marks.

68. Rain or shine

‘Rain or shine’ is used to express the phrase ‘no matter what’.

Example: Thanks to my father’s car, I was punctual for school everyday, rain or shine.

69. See eye to eye

When people 'see eye to eye', it means they agree.

Example: It was difficult for Tom and Jerry to see eye to eye as they had different ideas.

70. Slipped someone's mind

When something 'slips your mind', it means that you have forgotten about it.

Example: I had to bring an umbrella, but it slipped my mind.

71. Social butterfly

A social butterfly is someone who is very popular or friendly with others.

Example: Unlike Jenny, who was shy, Lisa was a social butterfly.

72. Spill the beans

To spill the beans is to reveal a secret.

Example: We wanted to surprise my brother for his birthday, but my mother accidentally spilled the beans.

73. Steal someone's thunder

To 'steal someone's thunder' is to take the limelight from someone else.

Example: I had won the race, but Ting Ting stole my thunder because she had stopped running to help a competitor who had fallen down.

74. Stir up a hornet's nest

To 'stir up a hornet's nest' is to create or cause a dangerous situation.

Example: It was best to avoid stirring up a hornet's nest and let the stray dog sleep.

75. Sweet tooth

Someone who has a sweet tooth likes sweet-tasting food a lot.

Example: As my mother knew I had a sweet tooth, she bought me a cake as a reward for scoring top marks.

76. Take a crack at it

To take a crack at something is to try doing something, especially when it is a difficult problem others could not fix.

Example: After my siblings failed to reach the cookie jar on the top shelf, I decided to take a crack at it by using a ladder.

77. The last straw

‘The last straw’ is used to describe the final problem that causes someone to lose patience.

Example: Ms Nabilah tolerated Charlie’s rude behaviour, but he had bullied another student and that was the last straw.

78. The best of both worlds

When you have 'the best of both worlds', it means you have the most ideal situation.

Example: Timothy had to decide between going to tuition or playing soccer with his friends. He wished he could have the best of both worlds, but it did not seem possible.

79. The icing on the cake

'The icing on the cake' is used to describe an additional benefit to something that is already good.

Example: The birthday party was amazing, and the presents I received were the icing on the cake.

80. The tip of the iceberg

'The tip of the iceberg' is used to describe a small part of a bigger problem.

Example: Breaking the ladder was just the tip of the iceberg. After falling off, Jessica was in so much pain, she could not even get up.

81. Think twice

To think twice about something is to reconsider an idea.

Example: We should always think twice when an online deal seems too good to be true.

82. Throw caution to the wind

To throw caution to the wind is to stop hesitating.

Example: Jack decided to throw caution to the wind and rode his bicycle down the ramp at top speed.

83. Turn a blind eye

To turn a blind eye to something is to pretend you did not see it.

Example: I could not turn a blind eye to someone in need, so I decided to stand up to the bully for Timothy.

84. Under the weather

To be under the weather is to be unwell.

Example: I was feeling under the weather and decided to skip a day of school.

85. Walking on air

When someone is walking on air, they are very happy.

Example: My mother bought me a new video game for my birthday, and I was walking on air for the rest of the day.

86. Wet blanket

A wet blanket is someone who spoils the fun.

Example: “Don’t be a wet blanket,” John said. “Climbing that tree is not dangerous at all!”

87. Wild goose chase

A wild goose chase is used to describe a useless pursuit.

Example: After running fifteen minutes, I realised there was no way I could catch up to the thief. It was a wild goose chase.

88. Wrap your head around something

To wrap your head around something is to understand it.

Example: I could not wrap my head around the last question of my homework. It kept me up all night.

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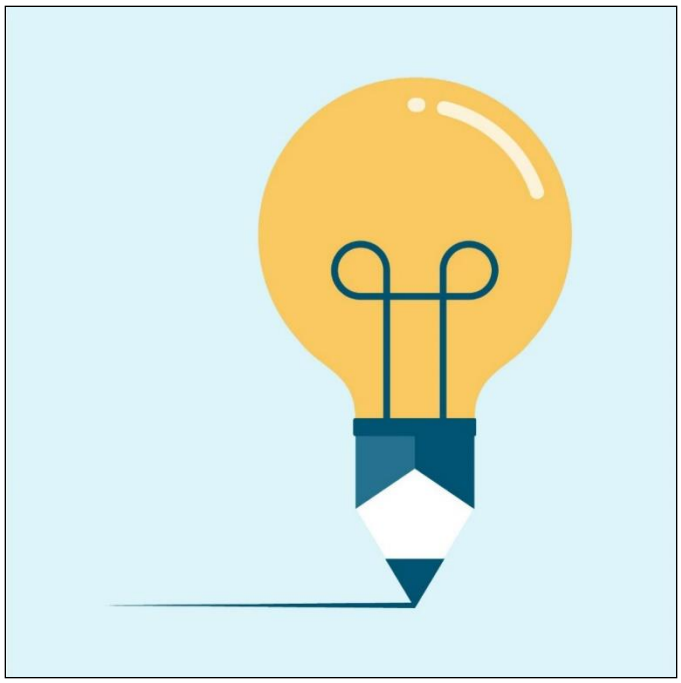

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